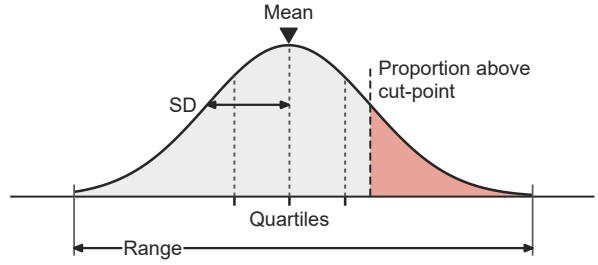
a

Ways a trial publication may report one covariate

Reporting pattern	Comparator trial (N = 300)
Mean (SD)	53.0 (12.0)
Median [Q1, Q3]	53.1 [45.0, 61.3]
Median (range)	53.1 (21.4–88.9)
Mean (SD), n (%) above cut-point	53.0 (12.0); 47 (15.7%) above 65
All of the above	53.0 (12.0); 53.1 [45.0, 61.3]; range 21.4–88.9; 47 (15.7%) above 65

b

Feature of the distribution captured by each summary



c

Summaries used by each method

Method	Mean	SD	Quartiles	Range	Proportion above cut-point
Unadjusted	–	–	–	–	–
MAIC (means)	●	–	–	–	–
MAIC (means and SDs)	●	●	–	–	–
MAIC (all reported summaries)	●	●	●	●	●
MAIC (means, quartiles and proportions)	●	–	●	●	●
sMAIC	●	○	○	●	●
STC	●	–	–	–	–
G-computation	▭	▭	–	–	–
G-MAIC (means and SDs)	▭●	▭●	–	–	–
G-MAIC	▭●	▭●	▭●	▭●	●
sG-MAIC	▭●	▭○	▭○	▭●	●

● Matched exactly

○ Matched within a tolerance

▭ Used to reconstruct the comparator covariate distribution

– Not used